

Game Aesthetics

The MDA (Mechanics-Dynamics-Aesthetics) model describes the three important elements of a game. The first one we'll be discussing is the Game Aesthetics. Game Aesthetics describes the emotional responses evoked in the player, when the player interacts with the game system. Aesthetic in short is the feeling that you want the player to have after/while playing the game. It describes the play experience of the player. The MDA model classified eight aesthetics in general that are seen in games and example games they can be observed in:

- ▶ Sensation: *Quake*
- ▶ Fantasy: *Final Fantasy, Sims, Quake, World of Warcraft*
- ▶ Narrative: *Final Fantasy, Sims, Quake*
- ▶ Challenge: *Charades, Quake, Final Fantasy*
- ▶ Fellowship: *Charades, World of Warcraft*
- ▶ Discovery: *L.A. Noire, Sims, Final Fantasy*
- ▶ Expression: *Charades, Sims, Final Fantasy*
- ▶ Submission: *Final Fantasy*

Game Mechanics

What really makes the game space a very interesting place to be are game mechanics. "A game mechanic" is another term for what others might commonly call a "rule." Among those in the industry, though, the term "mechanic" is commonplace. Mechanics are how something works. If you do X, then Y happens. If X is true, then you can do Y. In Monopoly, if you land on a property, you can buy it. If you roll the higher number, you get to go first. Each is a simple mechanic.

Designing Mechanics is as fun as cooking. Amazingly fun things can be made with the help of Game Mechanics. Mechanics are the rules of the game that act upon the players, avatars and game bits, game state and game views, and describe all of the ways to change the game state. Mechanics are in a way ingredients of Game Design.

Here are some common classes of mechanics that you can put in your game:

- ▶ **Setup:** There must always be at least one rule that describes how the game begins.
- ▶ **Victory conditions:** There must always be at least one rule that describes how the game is won. Some games, like open-ended role-playing games (RPGs), have no victory condition. As a result, some designers do not